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DJIA 53686.11 ▲ 624.16 1.18% NASDAQ 26584.06 ▲ 1.4% STOXX 600 649.10 ▲ 0.5% 10-YR. TREAS. ▲ 8/32, yield 4.761% OIL \$91.30 ▲ \$0.29 GOLD \$4,491.70 ▲ \$125.40 EURO \$1.1626 YEN 155.80

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Nvidia agreed** to buy artificial-intelligence startup Hugging Face in a deal valued at roughly \$13 billion, accelerating Nvidia's push to promote open-weight AI models and services. **A1**
- ◆ **Stocks climbed** and bond yields retreated on the heels of remarks by Fed governor Christopher Waller. The S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow rose 1.1%, 1.4% and 1.2%, respectively. **A2, B1**
- ◆ **Fox News parted** ways with longtime anchor Maria Bartiromo, announcing the separation after the journalist had been absent from the screen for almost a month. **B3**
- ◆ **The Dutch central bank** moved 78 metric tons of gold valued at \$11 billion from vaults in Manhattan to London, saying it would be easier to trade it from there. **B1**
- ◆ **Tesla rolled out** its steering-wheel-free Cybercabs on the roads of Austin, Texas, in the first public test of its ability to transition from traditional electric vehicles to fully autonomous cars. **B4**
- ◆ **Victoria's Secret** again boosted its full-year outlook, pointing to progress in its turnaround plan, even as second-quarter sales growth cooled. **B3**
- ◆ **Campbell's said** it cut more than 1,750 jobs, or roughly 13% of its workforce, as part of a cost-savings program to hasten a turnaround. **B3**
- ◆ **Tyson Foods said** revenue would grow by less than previously expected this year, citing volatile cattle prices amid a yearslong cattle shortage. **B3**
- ◆ **Docusign raised** its sales outlook for the second time this year, citing a boost from AI-related demand. **B3**

Worldwide

- ◆ **The Trump administration** proposed rules that would let the IRS strip tax-exempt status from private schools and colleges if the government determines that they engage in racial preferences or discrimination. **A3**
- ◆ **Bristol Myers Squibb** waited almost three months to publicly disclose that it had paused closely watched drug research because of safety concerns. **A3**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** again asked the Supreme Court to allow it to implement its proposed new rules on mail-in ballots, hoping to get them in place before the midterm elections. **A3**
- ◆ **The Justice Department** charged an immigration officer with lying about the events leading up to the on-duty shooting of a Venezuelan man in Minneapolis. **A3**
- ◆ **Leon Black sued** the House Oversight Committee probing his ties with Jeffrey Epstein and refused to turn over some nondisclosure agreements, arguing the panel and its chair overstepped their authority. **A4**
- ◆ **Vice President JD Vance** defended his friendship with former Fox News host Tucker Carlson, rejecting pressure from some Republicans to distance himself from the conservative iconoclast. **A4**
- ◆ **Ukraine plans** to step up the presence of its drones near Russian airports to compel their closure, while warning international airlines to re-evaluate the safety of flying there. **A7**
- ◆ **Died: Gloria Steinem**, 92, women's-rights activist. **A5**

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Gloria Steinem, Feminist Trailblazer, Dies at 92



BETTMANN ARCHIVE/GETTY IMAGES

STEADFAST: Gloria Steinem, co-founder of Ms. magazine, spent more than six decades as a journalist, editor, activist and organizer, while becoming a symbol of the women's movement. Steinem died Wednesday at her home in Manhattan. **A5**

Economies Across Mideast Face Poor Outlook as War Drags On

By OMAR ABDEL-BAQUI AND SUMMER SAID

DUBAI—When war arrived in this playground for the ultrarich in the Middle East this spring, its leaders like others across the Arab Gulf pinned their hopes on a brief conflict, expecting to roar back by the fall and end a disastrous period in their history.

Instead, they are writing the year off as a loss, people familiar with their thinking said, as fighting between the U.S. and Iran drags into its

seventh month and a bleak economic picture descends on the region.

Marquee events have been disrupted, and luxury hotels are largely empty and slashing staff as war risks keep air travelers away. The Bahrain Grand Prix Formula One race is still happening this October, but thousands of miles away in Malaysia.

Saudi Arabia, which has made a multibillion-dollar bet on videogames, moved the E-Sports World Cup to Paris from Riyadh, and Formula One

canceled April's race in the kingdom. The Abu Dhabi Grand Prix is still on the calendar for December, though Formula One said that could change depending on events. A music festival headlined by Shakira this year in the United Arab Emirates has been pulled.

Aviation, real estate, tourism, shipping and hotels continue to be hit hard across the region. Companies are dealing not only with a lack of demand but also shipping bottlenecks that have delayed deliveries of everything from heavy machin-

ery to kegs of imported beer.

"When this thing ends, it is still going to take six months for things to start to feel normal again," said Rafael Khanoyan, chief executive at U.A.E. contractor Al Ryum Group, who said shipment backlogs and rerouted containers have sharply increased the price of imported goods.

Arab Gulf leaders came into the summer expecting the violent phase of the war to wind down in favor of long negotiations over Iran's nuclear pro-

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TOMORROW



WSJ. MAGAZINE

OLIVIA DEAN

INSIDE



MANSSION

The six-figure keys unlocking access to private beaches on Martha's Vineyard. **M1**

Nothing Makes Humans Happier Than Watching Robots Fail

Genre delivers comedy, schadenfreude and a reassuring feeling of superiority

By JOHN JURGENSEN

Feeling a little terrified about how quickly technology seems to be sidelining humanity? Try watching a robot sprint straight into a wall. It's hilarious.

In recent videos showing machines on two legs running track in Beijing, some succeeded in breaking Usain Bolt's 100-meter record.

And some slammed full tilt into a barrier, collapsing and reeling like drunks. More than one

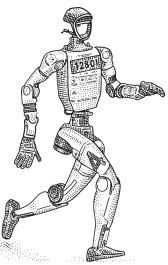
flopped backward in a cartoonish froth of sparks.

The World Humanoid Robot Games was intended to showcase a field evolving in literal leaps, with robots high-jumping, boxing and cheerleading.

More important, the exhibition was a source of fresh material for my new favorite genre of entertainment: robots failing spectacularly at basic human feats.

It's content that delivers pure physical comedy, guilt-free schadenfreude and a reassuring

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Klutzn

Chinese Warships Cruise Too Close for Japan's Comfort

Tokyo feels most severe security environment since World War II

By JASON DOUGLAS AND JUNKO FUKUTOME

SETOUCHI, Japan—The Chinese warships that sail close to the Japanese island of Amami-Oshima make Naruhito Kamada nervous.

A stocky former sumo wrestler, the Setouchi mayor worries there might be a collision one day in the narrow channel that connects the East China Sea with the Pacific Ocean.

"I feel a sense of crisis," Kamada said in an interview, his office a few hundred yards from the docks where fishing boats and whale-watching expeditions put out to sea.

Japanese surveillance has recorded Chinese destroyers passing through the strait near Amami-Oshima at least 10 times this year. That

follows zero such transits in 2025 and is on pace to exceed the 15 recorded in 2024.

"It's a provocation for sure," said Takuya Matsuda, an international security scholar at Aoyama Gakuin University in Tokyo.

Japan is facing what officials describe as the most severe security environment since World War II. China is flexing its growing military might, pressing maritime claims across eastern Asia and pushing deeper into the Western Pacific, where the U.S. has held sway for years.

Deepening alliances among Japan's neighbors—China, North Korea and Russia—have raised questions about the nation's security, as well as the security of vital sea lanes that connect its economy to the U.S. and beyond.

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Dutch Bank Moves \$11 Billion in Gold From NYC, Citing Geopolitical Unrest

By JOE STONOR AND JOE WALLACE

The Dutch central bank shifted the location of 78 metric tons of gold, valued at \$11 billion at today's prices, from vaults beneath the streets of Manhattan to London, saying it would improve the ability to trade the metal in a pinch.

The high-security operation took several months to pull off. Some of the gold was sold in the U.S. and repurchased in the U.K.

Other bars were flown to Europe, likely in the storage hold of planes.

The result: Almost a third of the Dutch gold reserve is in London and a still chunky 19% in New York, flipping their earlier positions.

"In view of increasing geo-

political unrest, DNB is strengthening its crisis preparedness," the central bank said in a statement referring to its Dutch acronym. The central bank also moved some gold from vaults in Canada.

"We expect that we will never need to use them, but we do need to strengthen our resilience and preparedness," said DNB President Olaf Sleijpen.

The bank didn't specify what it meant by geopolitical unrest.

The move follows 18 months in which relations between the U.S. and Europe have frayed over tariffs, President Trump's threats to seize Greenland and his equivocation over the U.S.'s military backing.

Gold's place as the backbone of global finance ended with the demise of the Bretton Woods monetary system in

the 1970s.

But central banks kept hold of some gold as part of reserves they could sell to defend their currencies if they came under strain.

After a long decline, central banks started adding to their gold holdings again around the time of the 2008 financial crisis, according to a 2023 paper by the International Monetary Fund.

Since then, proliferating sanctions have encouraged many central banks—notably Russia's—to stock up on gold in case the U.S. cut them off from its banking system.

Many central banks, including the Dutch, spread their gold eggs in different baskets around the world to keep them safe. New York and London

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